Music in Western Civilization

Topic 5.4: *Classicism and Beethoven: I* 貝多芬

**the year 2025 marked the 255th anniversary of Beethoven's birth.*

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- **Ludwig van Beethoven 1770-1827**
  born in Bonn, Germany
  died in Vienna, Austria



- From Classical to Romantic;
- Pianist and violinist;
- Lost hearing from around 1795;
- Larger formal structure, extended **coda** 乐章结尾部，完结部 , longer works, deeper mood & freer rhythm, emotionally expressive.
- **9 symphonies**, 6 piano concertos, 1 violin concerto, 1 triple concerto三重协奏曲(vn., vc. & pf.), 13 overtures序曲& occasional music, 18 string quartets弦乐四重奏, **32 piano sonatas**钢琴奏鸣曲, 10 violin sonatas, 3 operas, 5 extended choral works including 2 masses弥撒曲.

Beethoven-Haus, Bonngasse 20, Bonn, Germany





Heiligenstadt near Vienna, Beethoven Haus



Bagatelle No. 25 in A minor for solo piano,
commonly known as "***Für Elise***"*(For Alice)*

- The score was not published until 1867, forty years after the composer's death in 1827. The original autograph manuscript, now lost, had the title: "Für Elise am 27 April [1810] zur Erinnerung von L. v. Bthvn" ("For Elise on April 27 in memory from L. v. Bthvn").[4] The music was published as part of Nohl's *Neue Briefe Beethovens* (New letters by Beethoven) on pages 28 to 33, printed in Stuttgart by Johann Friedrich Cotta.

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=q5oSa4itomE Lang Lang

• Ludwig van Beethoven 1770-1827

- *Violin Sonata No.5, Op.24, 'Spring'*. Pub.1801
- Violinist: Anne-Sophie Mutter
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PGFs7n6n3-8

- **German Lied**德国艺术歌曲(English: song)：a Lied is simply a song or from its origin Volkslied (Folksong). It is written in German and is usually with a narrower range that can be sung by amateur singers. A Lied tells the story of folklore or nature with metaphor. Haydn and Beethoven had written several Lieder (songs). But it has to wait till Schubert舒伯特who had written over 600 Lieder, to popularize the artform.

- ***Ich liebe dich** (I Love You)*, 1795
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YXtbCEnIF-0 solo tenor: Peter Schreier

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I0GTN6x9Uls arranged for male chorus, South Korea. From 0:30
- Solo and chorus

Music: Beethoven, Text : Karl Friedrich Wilhelm Herrosee 1754-1821

- **Ich liebe dich**, so wie du mich,
  Am Abend und am Morgen,
  Noch war kein Tag, wo du und ich
  Nicht teilten unsre Sorgen.

  Auch waren sie für dich und mich
  Geteilt leicht zu ertragen;
  Du tröstetest im Kummer mich,
  Ich weint' in deine Klagen.

  Drum Gottes Segen über dir,
  Du, meines Lebens Freude.
  Gott schütze dich, erhalt' dich mir,
  Schütz und erhalt' uns beide.

  I love you as you love me,
  At evening and at morning,
  No day there was when you and I
  Did not share our sorrows.

  And for me and you they were,
  When shared, an easy burden;
  You comforted me in my distress,
  I wept when you lamented.

  May God then bless you,
  You, my life's delight.
  God protect and keep you for me,
  Protect and keep us both.

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- Of the 32 **Piano Sonatas** written by Beethoven, the *No.14: Moonlight* is surely a legendary work generally involving a blind young girl playing piano under moonlight.
- Background：https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Piano_Sonata_No._14_(Beethoven)

- ***Piano Sonata No.14, Op.27, No.2 "Quasi una fantasia"*, 1801**
- Five years after Beethoven's death, a music critic described the work as 'Moonlight' referring to its 1st movement.

- 1st movement：https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uNtm3O4bfz4
- Wilhelm Kempf. (*Moonlight or not?)*

- 3rd movement：https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zucBfXpCA6s Valentina Lisitsa
- The 3rd movement is fiery and passionate making this Sonata actually moving away from Classicism to Romanticism.

- ***Piano Sonata in C minor Op.13, Pathetique*** 悲愴, 1798

- Background : https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Piano_Sonata_No._8_(Beethoven)

- 1st movement: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=79gzdskOGu4 Barenboim
- beginning with a slow introduction leading into a fiery passage.

- 2nd Movement: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vGq3-Fi_zQY Barenboim
- Slow, has a very lyrical and an almost romantic theme.

- This theme was used more than 100 years later in a pop song style.
- *Midnight Blue*, sung by French singer Michele Torr
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Mi3kqBwLlWc French text

Chamber Music 室内乐

- Comparing with string quartets by Haydn and Mozart, Beethoven's *18 string quartets* are much freer and intense in atmosphere. The aristocratic noble feeling is subsiding and replaced by a personal expression of self.

- *String Quartet in F major, Op.59, 'Razumovsky'.*
- It was written for Prince Razumovsky, the then Russian Ambassador to Vienna. Note the cello starts the theme in the first movement.
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aG89Fdc1jk0 total duration: 41'20" . Alban Berg Quartet, Vienna

Egmont Overture, Op.84. 1810

after the play of the same name by Goethe, on the 16th century Dutch hero the Count of Egmont.

- Sergio Celibidache 1912-96. Berlin Philharmonic Orchestra. 1948
- Ruins of the Philharmonie
- Sergiu Celibidache Dirigent Berliner Philharmoniker 1948 (youtube.com)

- Saito Kinen Orchestra斋藤纪念管絃乐团.
- Conductor: Seiji Ozawa小泽征尔 1935-2024 , born in Shenyang
- Saito Kinen Orchestra was formed every August-September since 1984 to commemorate Hideo Saito斋藤秀雄, founder of Toho Gakuen School of Music 桐朋学園 音楽部門 (est. 1948)
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AoAlouGwS_4

Beethoven: Piano Concerto No.5 'Emperor' in Eb major, Op.73. 1809

- Piano: Ashkenazy, conductor: Bernard Haitink
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V4pJxad_aI8
- London Philharmonic Orchestra, 1974

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=u8kCXpD7k6k
- Leipzig Gewandhaus Orchester, Kurt Masur. Piano: Elisabeth Leonskaja
- 1989 Suntory Hall, Tokyo

Beethoven: ***Triple Concerto***

for violin, cello and piano Op.56. 1803
written for the Archduke Rudolf of Austria

- Anne-Sophie Mutter, Daniel Barenboim, Yo-Yo Ma
- West-eastern Divan Orchestra

- 2nd movement
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=452nsCCzIJs

- With interview
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J13-W8SN-sU

- Symphony with a title
- Symphony of the Classical Period usually does not carry a title and is referred to as *absolute music* *无标题音乐.* Beethoven began to put a descriptive title in four of his nine symphonies. Symphony No.6 'Pastoral' has five movements with subtitles for every movement describing the scenes of nature and is generally referred to as the first *programmed symphony*. It opens up the favorite category of music known as *Programmed Music* *标题音乐。*

- 9 Symphonies: *No. 3 Eroica* *英雄*
- *No. 5 Fate* *命运*
- *No. 6 Pastoral* *田园*
- *No. 9 Choral, 'Ode to Joy'* *合唱交响曲"欢乐颂"*

Symphony No.5 'Fate' in c minor, op.67

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jv2WJMVPQi8

- **West-Eastern Divan Orchestra**. Formed in 1999 in Weimar, Germany by **Barenboim.**
- Musicians are of Egyptian, Iranian, Israeli, Jordanian, Lebanese, Palestinian, Syrian and Spanish background.
- 4th movement 23'07"

- https://west-eastern-divan.org/

Ludwig van Beethoven



I am resolved to rise superior to every obstacle. With whom need I be afraid of measuring my strength? I will take Fate by the throat. It shall not overcome me. O how beautiful it is to be alive - would that I could live a thousand times!

AZ QUOTES